(adopted on 27 June 2025)

REVISED RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ENTERING

ENCLOSED SPACES ABOARD SHIPS

THE MARITIME SAFETY COMMITTEE,

RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization

concerning the functions of the Committee

RECALLING ALSO its adoption, by resolution A.864(20), of the Recommendations for entering

enclosed spaces aboard ships , and by resolution A.1050(27), of the Revised

recommendations for entering enclosed spaces aboard ships , incorporating therein

recommendations for entering cargo spaces, tanks, pump-rooms, fuel tanks, cofferdams, duct

keels, ballast tanks and similar enclosed spaces,

RECALLING FURTHER that SOLAS regulation III/19.3.6 requires enclosed space entry and

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keels, ballast tanks and similar enclosed spaces,

RECALLING FURTHER that SOLAS regulation III/19.3.6 requires enclosed space entry and

rescue drills, SOLAS regulation XI-1/7 requires the carrying of atmosphere testing
instrument

for enclosed spaces, and SOLAS chapter IX and the ISM Code require management for the

safe operation of ships,

RECALLING that the Maritime Safety Committee is requested to keep the revised

recommendations under review and amend them as necessary,

BEING CONCERNED about the continued loss of life resulting from personnel entering

shipboard spaces in which the atmosphere is unable to support life, owing to oxygen
depletion,

oxygen enrichment, toxicity or flammability,

BEING AWARE of the work undertaken in this regard by the International Labour Organization,

Governments and segments of the private sector,

RECOGNIZING that organizational leadership plays a crucial role in successful

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Governments and segments of the private sector,

RECOGNIZING that organizational leadership plays a crucial role in successful

implementation of this guidance by empowering shipboard staff to make the right decisions,

HAVING CONSIDERED , at its 110th session, the recommendation made by the

Sub-Committee on Carriage of Cargoes and Containers at its tenth session,

1 ADOPTS the Revised recommendations for entering enclosed spaces aboard ships,

as set out in the annex to the present resolution;

2 INVITES Governments to bring the annexed Revised Recommendations to the

attention of shipowners, ship operators, seafarers, port and terminal operators and port

workers, urging them to apply them, as appropriate, to all ships and operations;

3 INVITES the Assembly to revoke resolution A.1050(27) and to endorse the action

taken by the Maritime Safety Committee.

RESOLUTION MSC.581(110) (adopted on 27 June 2025)

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ANNEX

REVISED RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ENTERING

ENCLOSED SPACES ABOARD SHIPS

Preamble

The objective of these recommendations is to encourage the adoption of safety procedures and

the development of sound practices aimed at preventing casualties to, and enhancing the safety

of, personnel entering or working in enclosed spaces where there may be an oxygen-deficient,

oxygen-enriched, flammable and/or toxic atmosphere. Additionally, in the event of an emergency

within an enclosed space, these recommendations provide guidance for an appropriate, planned

and considered response complying with ship-specific enclosed space rescue plans.

Investigations into the circumstances of enclosed space accidents have shown that a failure to

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Investigations into the circumstances of enclosed space accidents have shown that a failure to

systematically identify the hazards, assess the risks and implement an appropriate entry procedure

remains a significant factor in many accidents. Likewise, the complex structure of some spaces on

board ships creates problems with appropriate ventilation, illumination and movement within the

space. Organizational leadership on ship and shore plays a crucial role in successful

implementation of this guidance by empowering shipboard staff to make the right decisions.

These recommendations apply to all types of ships and provide guidan